INCH-POUND

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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHICKENS AND CHICKEN PARTS, READY-TO-COOK, CHILLED AND FROZEN

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification PP-C-248K.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers chilled and frozen chickens and chicken parts, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The chickens and chicken parts shall conform to the following types, classes, styles, necks and giblet options, weight ranges, and U.S. grades in the following list, which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

- **Type I** - Fresh chilled, ready-to-cook
- **Type II** - Frozen, ready-to-cook
- **Type III** - Individually quick frozen (IQF), ready-to-cook

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8905

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Classes.
- Class A - Broiler/Fryers
- Class B - Roasters
- Class C - Capons
- Class D - Fowl (Hens)
- Class E - Rock Cornish Game hens (Cornish Game hens)

Styles.
- Style 1 - Ready-to-cook, Whole
- Style 2 - Ready-to-cook, Halves (split)
- Style 3 - Ready-to-cook, Quarters
- Style 4 - Ready-to-cook, Cut-up, 8-pieces
- Style 5 - Ready-to-cook, Cut-up, 8-pieces (without back)
- Style 6 - Ready-to-cook, Cut-up, 9-pieces
- Style 7 - Ready-to-cook, Cut-up, 9-pieces (without back)
- Style 8 - Ready-to-cook, Parts (see section 3.4 for specific parts)
- Style 9 - Ready-to-cook, Parts, boneless (see section 3.4 for specific parts)
- Style 10 - Ready-to-cook, Parts, skinless (see section 3.4 for specific parts)
- Style 11 - Ready-to-cook, Parts, boneless and skinless (see section 3.4 for specific parts)

Necks and giblets options.
- Option (a) - With necks and giblets
- Option (b) - Without necks or giblets

Weight ranges. - As specified

U.S. Grades.
- Option (1) - U.S. Grade A
- Option (2) - U.S. Grade B
- Option (3) - U.S. Grade C

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Basic requirements: The chickens shall have been produced, raised, and processed in the United States, its territories and possessions, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, or the Trust Territories of the Pacific Islands. Slaughtering, eviscerating, processing, chilling and freezing (temperatures) shall be in accordance with Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS), Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 381). Poultry which has been shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) FSIS or Poultry Products Grading Certificate, certifying grade, class, condition, and slaughter date. Grading shall be in accordance with the regulations and the U.S. standards and grades for ready-to-cook poultry in 7 CFR Part 70.

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Unless otherwise specified, the chickens and chicken parts shall not have been processed and packaged prior to the date of the contract.

Frozen product shall conform to the standards for the specific grade as outlined in 7 CFR Part 70.

3.2 Types:

Type I - Fresh chilled, (ready-to-cook). The product shall be processed, packaged and packed, and delivered within 5 calendar days after slaughter.

Chilling of the product shall comply with the requirements of 9 CFR § 381.66(b). The product shall be delivered to destination at an internal temperature of not higher than 40 °F (4 °C) and not lower than 26 °F (-3.3 °C). Destination temperature will be taken in the breast or thigh in the bulk of the meat.

Type II - Frozen (ready-to-cook). The product shall be processed, packaged and packed, and placed in a freezer within 7 calendar days after slaughter.

The product shall be chilled in accordance with 9 CFR § 381.66(b). The product shall be placed in a freezer within 48 hours after packaging and packing. If the chilled product is not placed in a freezer immediately after packaging or packing, the product shall be held at a room temperature not higher than 36 °F (2.2 °C) and not lower than 26 °F (-3.3 °C).

The packaged or packed product shall be frozen in accordance with 9 CFR Part 381 [internal product temperature lowered to 0 °F (-17.8 °C) or lower within 72 hours from the time of entering the freezer]. If the packaged or packed product is held at a room temperature below 26 °F (-3.3 °C), the 72 hour freezing time will begin at the end of the shift the product entered the 26 °F (-3.3 °C) or lower facility.

Type III - IQF (ready-to-cook). The individually quick frozen option may be specified for any cut-up or parts options. The product shall be processed, packaged and packed, and placed in a freezer within 7 calendar days after slaughter.

The parts shall be chilled in accordance with 9 CFR § 381.66(b). If the product is not individually frozen or placed into a freezer after chilling and processing, it must be held at a room temperature not higher than 36 °F (2.2 °C) and not lower than 26 °F (-3.3 °C).

The parts shall be frozen in a manner that will prevent them from sticking together after freezing. The packaged and packed IQF product shall be frozen in compliance with 9 CFR Part 381 [internal product temperature lowered to 0 °F (-17.8 °C) or lower within 72 hours from the time of entering the freezer].

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3.3 Classes:

Class A - Broiler/Fryers. These are young chickens (usually less than 13 weeks of age), of either sex, that are tender-meated with soft, pliable, smooth-textured skin and flexible breastbone cartilage.

Class B - Roasters. These are young chickens (usually 3 to 5 months of age), of either sex, that are tender-meated with soft, pliable, smooth-textured skin and breastbone cartilage that may be somewhat less flexible than that of a broiler or fryer.

Class C - Capons. Capons are surgically neutered male chickens (usually less than 8 months of age) that are tender-meated with soft, pliable, smooth-textured skin.

Class D - Fowl (hens). Birds of this class are mature female chickens (usually more than 10 months of age) with meat less tender than that of roaster or roasting chickens and nonflexible breastbone tip.

Class E - Rock Cornish Game hens (Cornish Game hens). Rock Cornish Game hens or Cornish Game hens are young, immature chickens (usually 5 to 6 weeks of age) weighing not more than 2 pounds ready-to-cook weight, which were derived from a Cornish chicken or the progeny of a Cornish chicken crossed with another breed of chicken.

3.4 Styles: Individual carcasses and parts of ready-to-cook chickens shall conform to definitions and standards found in 9 CFR Part 381 and/or 7 CFR Part 70, except where otherwise noted in this document.

The neck shall be separated at its junction with the body. The separation of all parts shall be accomplished at the joints or separation points described in 7 CFR § 70.210. All cuts shall be in a neat manner without mutilation of adjacent muscle and/or bone and without producing bone splinters. The cuts may be made using any mechanical means, provided the cuts are proper or as described in this document.

Style 1 - Whole. The poultry carcass, excluding or including the neck and giblets, as specified.

Style 2 - Halves (split). The carcass shall be cut by making a full-length back and breast split cut separating the carcass into two approximately equal right and left sides.

Style 3 - Quarters. The carcass shall be cut into four equal parts, 2 breast quarters with wings attached, and 2 leg quarters. (The neck shall not be included.)

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Style 4 - Cut-up, 8 pieces. 2 wings, 2 drumsticks, 2 breast quarters without wings (2 breast halves with back portions), and 2 thighs with back portions.

Style 5 - Cut-up, 8 pieces (without back). 2 wings, 2 drumsticks, 2 thighs, and 2 breast portions with vertebral ribs. (No part of the back, except the vertebral ribs, shall be included in Style 5.)

Style 6 - Cut-up, 9 pieces. 2 wings, 2 drumsticks, 2 thighs with back portions, and 3 breast portions (one without and two with back portions). Make a crosswise cut into the carcass to produce a front section (breast portion with back) and a rear section (thigh portion with back). The front section of the chicken shall be divided first by a crosswise cut at the front part of the breast starting at a point approximately ½-inch in front of the keel bone and proceeding at a 45-degree angle to the backbone toward the posterior part of the breast. Divide the remaining breast section by a lengthwise cut along the backbone and center portion of the breast.

Style 7 - Cut-up, 9 pieces (without back). 2 wings, 2 drumsticks, 2 thighs, and 3 breast portions (one without and two with vertebral ribs). The cut to exclude the back shall be made by a cut starting at the shoulder joint, going backwards adjacent and parallel to the vertebral column. Alternatively, the cut can be made in the opposite direction if the location of the cut is as aforesaid. The front section of the chicken shall be divided first by a crosswise cut at the front part of the breast starting at a point approximately ½-inch in front of the keel bone and proceeding at a 45-degree angle to the backbone toward the posterior part of the breast. Divide the remaining breast section into approximately equal pieces by a lengthwise cut through the center portion of the breast. (No part of the back, except for the vertebral ribs, shall be included in Style 7.)

Style 8 - Parts. Parts, pieces, or portions may be cut in any manner complying with section 3.4 and 7 CFR Part 70 provided they are specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order and correctly labeled (i.e. drumsticks, thighs, thighs with back portion, wings, drummettes, legs, breasts (with or without ribs), breast halves (with or without ribs), breast quarters (with or without ribs), front chicken halves, rear chicken halves).

Style 9 - Parts, boneless. Boneless parts or portions may be cut in any manner complying with section 3.4 and 7 CFR Part 70 provided they are specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order and correctly labeled (i.e. drumsticks, boneless; thighs, boneless; legs, boneless; breasts (with or without rib meat), boneless; breast halves (with or without rib meat), boneless; breast quarters (with or without rib meat), boneless).

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Style 10 - Parts, skinless. Skinless parts or portions may be cut in any manner complying with section 3.4 and 7 CFR Part 70 provided they are specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order and correctly labeled (i.e. drumsticks, skinless; thighs, skinless; thighs with back portion, skinless; legs, skinless; breasts (with or without ribs), skinless; breasts halves (with or without ribs), skinless).

Style 11 - Parts, boneless and skinless. Boneless and skinless parts or portions may be cut in any manner complying with section 3.4 and 7 CFR Part 70 provided they are specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order and correctly labeled (i.e. drumsticks, boneless and skinless; thighs, boneless and skinless; legs, boneless and skinless; breasts (with or without rib meat), boneless and skinless; breast halves (with or without rib meat), boneless and skinless; breast quarters (with or without rib meat), boneless and skinless; tenderloins).

3.5 Necks and giblets:

With necks and giblets. The necks and giblets shall be placed together in accordance with commonly accepted commercial practice and 9 CFR Part 381 in natural proportions, or as specified in the procurement data.

Without necks and giblets. Self-explanatory.

3.6 Weight ranges: The procuring data shall include the weight ranges for whole, ready-to-cook carcasses; for cut-up and parts options, the data shall include the weight range for the individual part, or the weight range of the carcasses from which the parts are derived. The data shall state whether the weight does or does not include necks and giblets at the time of weighing. Separate weight requirements for individual shipping containers or smaller units may also be specified provided these are considered acceptable in current commercial practice.

Style 1 - Whole. Whole carcasses, with or without necks and giblets, will be placed in a plastic-film bag and packed in each shipping container to the net weight specified in the procurement data.

Style 2 - Style 11, Halves; Quarters; Cut-up, 8 pieces; Cut-up, 9-pieces; and all other Parts. The product shall be packaged proportionately in plastic-film bags, and 4 plastic-film bags shall be packed in each shipping container to a net weight of 40 pounds.

3.7 U.S. Grades: Grading shall be performed under the supervision of a USDA grader in accordance with standards of quality set forth in 7 CFR Part 70. The chickens and chicken parts shall meet all requirements for U.S. Grade A, B, or C, as specified in the procurement data. Boneless and/or skinless parts are eligible for U.S. Grade A only.

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3.8 Skinless, boneless, and boneless and skinless parts:

Skinless parts. The skin shall be removed in a manner without undue mutilation of the adjacent muscle. Grade A quality skinless parts shall comply with the requirements found within 7 CFR Part 70.

Boneless parts. The bone or bone-like material shall be removed in a neat manner without undue mutilation to the adjacent muscle. Grade A quality boneless parts shall comply with requirements found within 7 CFR Part 70.

Boneless and skinless parts. The bone, bone-like material, and skin shall be removed in a manner without undue mutilation to the adjacent muscle. Grade A quality boneless and skinless parts shall comply with the requirements found within 7 CFR § 70.231 and § 70.232.

3.9 Packaging and packing: Packaging and packing shall be in accordance with current commercial practices that are commercially acceptable for consumer- or institutional-type packaging and packing.

3.9.1 Packaging and packing tolerances: Chicken parts or portions in any individual carton, bag, or shipping container need not come from the same whole chicken. The tolerances for parts count shall be as specified in this CID or as otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and based on the shipping container.

For Style 1, Option (a) - Whole, with necks and giblets. The number of necks and giblets (hearts, livers, and gizzards) shall each not exceed that of natural proportions for the number of whole carcasses in the shipping container. NOTE: Any of the individual giblets components may number fewer than the maximum allowed.

For Style 3 - Quarters. When only chicken quarters are packed within the same shipping container, the difference between the number of breast quarters and leg quarters in the shipping containers shall not exceed two.

For Styles 4, 5, 6, and 7 - Cut-up 8 pieces, 8 pieces without back, 9 pieces, and 9 pieces without back. The number and kind of pieces in each shipping container shall be proportional both in number and kind to those found in a whole chicken. Additionally, the following applies:

Thighs, drumsticks, and breast pieces. The difference between the part having the least pieces and the part having the most pieces in the shipping container shall not be more than four.

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Wings. Other chicken parts in approximately natural proportions may be substituted for wings in any cut-up option. The wings shall not exceed the number of pieces of the part (breast, thigh, or drumstick) in the shipping container having the greatest number of pieces. For example, if a shipping container of eight-piece option product contains 42 breast pieces, 38 thighs, and 39 drumsticks, wings could not exceed 42.

For the nine-piece option. The number of breast pieces equivalent to an eight-piece cut shall be determined by dividing the total number of breast pieces by 1-1/2 and rounding to the next higher whole number. The resulting number will then be used to determine compliance with the four-piece variation between thighs, drumsticks, and breast pieces. Fractions should be rounded to the next higher whole number.

Examples:

Eight-piece option - A shipping container has 31 thighs, 30 drumsticks, 27 breast pieces, and 32 wings. In this example, the thighs, drumsticks, and breast pieces are within the permitted range of 4, but since the wings exceed the number of the other part with the greatest number of pieces in the shipping container (32 wings exceeds 31 thighs), the product does not meet tolerance requirements.

Nine-piece option - A shipping container has 27 thighs, 31 drumsticks, 43 breast pieces, and 22 wings. Breast piece calculation = 43/1.5 = 28.67 (rounded to the next higher whole number = 29). In this example, all parts are within permitted tolerance.

3.10 Marking and labeling: Shipping containers shall be marked and labeled as prescribed in the applicable contract or solicitation document(s). The marking and labeling of the product shall be in accordance with the requirements of 9 CFR Part 381. The labels shall be approved by the Standards and Labeling Division, FSIS, USDA, prior to use [9 CFR § 381.134(a)].

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The chickens and chicken parts shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in compliance with all applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The delivered chickens and chicken parts shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the chickens and chicken parts within the commercial marketplace. Delivered chickens and chicken parts shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The chickens and chicken parts shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same chickens and chicken parts offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Grading Branch, Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying agency and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable Poultry Division procedures. The chickens and chicken parts shall be examined or tested for compliance to the product requirements in the CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

1. Type(s)
2. Class(es)
3. Style(s) (note: For Parts, indicate the name of the specific part.)
4. Neck and giblet option(s), when applicable
5. Weight ranges of carcasses (note: Indicate whether weight does or does not include necks and giblets.)
6. U.S. Grade
7. Packaging and packing requirements
8. Marking and labeling requirements (including shipping container markings)
9. Offer unit sizes

7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Source of information for nongovernmental documents is as follows:

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Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

7.2.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the *Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations* are contained in 7 CFR Parts 53 to 209 and 9 CFR Parts 200 to end. The Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. These documents may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for *Condition of Food Containers* are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 1911-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - PY

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